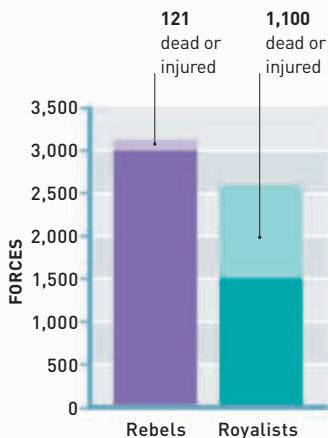




Argentine general José de San Martín with his horse and officers.



Battle of Chacabuco

A bold risk by rebel leader José de San Martín resulted in a highly successful ambush against the Spanish, who sustained heavy losses.

THE FIGHT AGAINST SPANISH rule took a decisive turn when Argentine-born General **José de San Martín** (1778–1850) led around 3,000 troops from Argentina into Chile through treacherous passages in the **Andes** mountains, and launched a surprise attack on royalist forces on February 12—the **Battle of Chacabuco**. He then moved on to take Santiago. He refused the offer of governorship of Chile, passing it instead to fellow soldier **Bernardo O'Higgins** (c. 1776–1842), who became the territory's "supreme director."

Serbia had also been fighting once more for independence, after being invaded by the Turks in 1813. The **Second Serbian Uprising** was successful, and most of their former rights were regained by 1817.

“LET US BE FREE. THE REST MATTERS NOT!”

José de San Martín, revolutionary leader

THE BATTLE IN ARABIA, ongoing since 1811 between Egypt and the Wahhabi sect of Islam, drew to a close in 1818. Egyptian forces led by Muhammad Ali recaptured the holy cities of Mecca and Medina. **Wahhabi** power had spread quickly, and from their Arabian base they had secured control of Mecca, Medina, and Jedda. Syria was under threat when Muhammad Ali received his orders to defeat the Wahhabi and return the cities to Ottoman rule. A final siege of the capital **Diriyah** (in present-day Saudi Arabia) put a temporary end to Wahhabi ambitions.

In South America, the effort led by José de San Martín at the Battle of Maipú on April 5 secured **independence for Chile** when loyalist troops suffered a crushing defeat. With a small naval fleet of seven ships under the command of British mercenary Lord Thomas Cochrane, the rebels also managed to break the Spanish hold on the coastline.

In Paris, German inventor Baron Karl von Drais de Sauerbrun was impressing crowds with a display of his **draisienne**, a two-wheeled machine that was the precursor to the modern **bicycle**. Made of wood and propelled by pushing the feet along the ground, rather than by pedals, it was known in German as the **Laufmaschine**, or "running machine." While testing the design the previous year, he had managed to ride it 9 miles (14 km). The idea was soon picked up and modified by other inventors,



Mary Shelley

The English novelist Mary Shelley published her first novel, *Frankenstein*, in 1818, and it remains a literary classic today.

including Briton **Denis Johnson** (c. 1759–1833), a coachmaker by training, who designed a "pedestrian curricule," later known as a **dandy horse**.

In England, **Mary Shelley** (1797–1851), the daughter of writer Mary Wollstonecraft (see 1792) and wife of poet Percy Bysshe Shelley (1792–1822), published the novel *Frankenstein; or, The Modern Prometheus*. The novel concerns a scientist who artificially creates another human being, and the consequences they both suffer. The work was an instant success, and is considered a classic work of **Gothic** literature as well as one of the earliest examples of science fiction.



A depiction of the Peterloo Massacre in which a peaceful political protest in Manchester, England, was attacked by armed cavalymen.

ON AUGUST 16, A POLITICAL RALLY of around 60,000 people on St. Peter's Field in Manchester, England, turned from a protest about high food prices and lack of popular suffrage into the **Peterloo Massacre**. Magistrates, concerned about the size of the crowd, ordered the Yeomanry (voluntary cavalry officers) to arrest the speakers, but they **attacked** the crowd when they refused to make way. A regiment, the 15th Hussars, was then sent in, and an estimated 15 people were killed and more than 500 injured.

Upon his return from exile, Venezuelan general **Simón Bolívar** had begun to make considerable headway against royalist forces. In

1819, he led his troops from Venezuela over the Andes to launch an attack. The Spanish were defeated at the **Battle of Boyacá** on August 7 and Bolívar marched south to Santa Fé de Bogotá, which secured the independence of **New Granada**. Bolívar was named the president of the new Republic of Colombia.

In a bid to challenge Dutch dominance of trade routes between China and India (see 1795) the British East India Company sought a new base in the Malay peninsula. **Stamford Raffles** arrived in **Singapore**, which was then part of the Riau-Johor empire. He negotiated a deal with the local ruler and founded a port.



THE EAST INDIA COMPANIES

The East India Companies monopolized trade between Europe and Southeast Asia, India, and the Far East from the early 17th century. However, the French Compagnie Française des Indes Orientales ceased trading at the time of the French Revolution (see 1789). The charter for the Dutch Vereenigde Oost-Indische Compagnie was revoked in 1799 when the government took control of it. Sweden's Svenska Ostindiska Companiet folded in 1813, while Britain's East India Company (above) traded until 1874.

March 8
New York Stock
Exchange founded

November
Third Maratha War
(to 1818)

Argentine general José de San
Martín (1778–1850) wins
decisive victory against
Spanish in Chile

Wahhabis defeated
by Egyptian forces

April 5 Battle of Maipú
secures Chilean
independence

Haitian president Jean
Pierre Boyer (1776–1850)
unites divided island

English writer Mary
Shelley (1797–1851)
publishes *Frankenstein*

Dutch take Malacca
back from Britain

February 15 Congress of
Angostura begins (until July 31,
1821) and establishes **Republic of
Colombia**, comprising New Granada,
Venezuela, and Quito (Ecuador)

February 22 Spain cedes Pacific
Northwest and Florida to the US
(Mexico) agreed under
Adams-Onís Treaty

August 16 Peterloo Massacre
in Britain when troops
charged a protesting crowd
in Manchester, killing 15
and injuring hundreds